

Identity Theft: What To Do Now

A step-by-step response and recovery record

Use this checklist if your personal information, account, card, device, mail, or identity may have been misused. Move quickly, use official contact information, and write down every step you take.

First 24 hours

- 1

Stop further exposure. Change passwords for affected accounts; secure your primary email first; sign out of unknown devices; and do not click links or call numbers from suspicious messages.
- 2

Contact the company or financial institution. Use the number on your statement, card, or official website. Ask it to freeze, close, dispute, or secure the affected account as appropriate.
- 3

Preserve information. Save account alerts, emails, screenshots, transaction details, case numbers, dates, and names of representatives.
- 4

Report and recover. Use IdentityTheft.gov for identity-theft reporting and recovery steps. Report scams or fraud at ReportFraud.ftc.gov. Call 911 for immediate danger or a crime in progress.

Account and credit protection

- ☐ Review bank, card, payment-app, mobile-carrier, and online-shopping activity.
- ☐ Ask affected companies what account-security or dispute steps apply.
- ☐ Consider a fraud alert or credit freeze with the nationwide credit reporting agencies.

Also do this

- ☐ Turn on multi-factor authentication and use new, unique passwords.
- ☐ Monitor mail, bills, benefits, tax notices, insurance notices, and credit reports for unfamiliar activity.
- ☐ Do not pay an unsolicited “recovery” company or share passwords/verification codes.

Incident summary

Date first noticed	How it was discovered	Information / account involved	Immediate action taken

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Recovery and follow-up log Write down each call, report, dispute, and reset

Date / time	Company or agency	Representative / contact method	Case / ref. no.	Action / follow-up date



Important reminders: use independently found contact information, not a number or link supplied by a suspected scammer. Keep copies of reports and correspondence in one secure place. For identity-theft recovery steps and personalized documents, use [IdentityTheft.gov](https://www.identitytheft.gov).

FTC REPORT NUMBER

CREDIT FREEZE / FRAUD ALERT PLACED WITH

BANK OR CARD FRAUD CASE NUMBER